

◆ CHAPTER 05 • RETURN

FIRST LIGHT – the full daily protocol

DATE Sun 13 Sep 2026

HM SEP 27 • TMM JAN 17 • 70.3 FEB 17 • 100K DEC 27 • IRONMAN JAN 28

THE COVENANT – THE 5 THAT ANCHOR THE DAY

☐ WAKE before 4:30 AM☐ MEDITATION – Brahma Muhurta, 4:45 AM☐ WORKOUT☐ JOURNAL☐ SLEEP 6.5H+ – lights out 9:45 PMThe wake is won at **lights-out**, not at the alarm – that is the one to defend. Miss it and tomorrow is already decided.

DAY MODE – PICK ONE AT WAKE. ALL THREE KEEP THE STREAK.

☐ FULL everything on this sheet☐ KEYSTONE the ★ items only – late
wake, travel, heavy load☐ ANCHOR the Covenant only – ill,
wrecked, broken sleepA smaller day is not a failed day. KEYSTONE and ANCHOR hold the streak and carry **no penance**. The only failed day is an unlogged one.

IF THE MORNING IS ALREADY LOST – DO NOT RUN THE CHAIN FROM WHERE YOU WOKE

1. Drop to **KEYSTONE**. Do not attempt the full chain – it will eat the 9:00 open.
2. Sit **3 minutes** in place of the full Brahma Muhurta block. Three minutes counts.
3. Rejoin at the next **FIXED** event below. Everything between them is compressible.

FIXED – 6:00 AM in the water • 9:00 AM market open • 7:00 PM laptop close + phone off • 9:45 PM lights out
Never push rituals into the night to “finish” the day. That buys one checkbox with tomorrow’s morning – it is how nine days get lost.

◇ RETURN RAMP – BACK FROM THE FEVER BREAK (SEP 4–12). THE RAMP COSTS STUDY TIME, NEVER RITUAL TIME.

W1	Sep 13–19	wake 4:30 AM	lights out 9:45 PM	Study 1+2 → 40 min ◀ THIS WEEK
W2	Sep 20–26	wake 4:00 AM	lights out 9:15 PM	Study 1+2 → 65 min
W3	Sep 27 onward	wake 3:30 AM	lights out 8:45 PM	Study 1+2 → full 90 min

◆ DEEP WORK – THE TWO MISSIONS

☐

STOCK MARKET STUDY

☐

INTERVIEW PREP & CODING

◇ 25 MORNING RULE Today's rule from the 25 Daily Rules. Read. Absorb. Apply. → # _____

◇ SPEAK ALOUD

On waking: Thanks – universe, everyone, five elements.**Morning • Ikigai:** "I am not trying to win. I am refusing to stop."**Pre-workout:** Box breathing 4-4-4-4 ×5 → go.**5:20 PM (wrap-up):** "Shutdown complete."**Morning & Night • Ho'oponopono:** "I love you. I'm sorry. Please forgive me. Thank you."**Kaizen:** "Tomorrow I improve one thing by 1%."

◇ FOOD CODE

Rice OK • no fried • no processed sugar

Chew 32× • no phone/laptop while eating

Hara Hachi Bu – eat to 80% full**Lunch = biggest meal** (athlete portion) • 5 PM
top-up on big days**Night = milk + paneer only** – nothing after

Shata Pada – 100 steps after every meal

Warm water only w/ meals – never cold (Agni)

Protein ×4 meals – whey / paneer / dahi / sattvEat order: salad+dal first • roti last • millet
> white riceTea/coffee ≥1h from meals • **last caffeine 2 PM**

Water ~3L/day • 1 anthocyanin fruit

(jamun/berries/amla)

◇ ANCHORS

Sleep: lights out 9:45 PM • Fri+Sat 15 min
earlier → wake 4:30 AM (6.5h = covenant floor)**Wake before 4:30 AM** – no snooze, ever**Swim 6:00 SHARP daily exc WED** • WED long run 5AM

• TUE run 4:15PM • TUE/THU/FRI gym 7:30 • SAT

ride 60-90' • SUN TRI (ride+brick) • market 9-3

Races: HM Sep 27 • TMM Jan 17 • 70.3 Feb 17

No sleep 4 AM – 5 PM (watch-tracked)**Brahmacharya** – Ojas conserved & raisedThe wake is decided at 9:45 PM the night before
– not at the alarm

★ = tier-1, non-negotiable

◇ WRITE – FILL THROUGH THE DAY

4:45 AM _____ one thing
 Micro-
 gratitude

Night • _____
 3 wins

Tomorrow, _____
 1% better

RAMP WEEK 1 – the times below are the full 3:30 chain. This week you wake at 4:30 AM: run the oral-care and Brahma Muhurta blocks in the order printed, just 60 min later. Study 1+2 absorbs the entire cut – nothing else shrinks. From 5:40 (pre-train) onward the sheet is exact: the 6:00 water and the 9:00 open do not move. WEDNESDAY is the exception – the long run goes at 5:00 and cannot shift, so there is NO study block: wake, minimum rituals, out the door.

WAKE – ORAL CARE (3:30-3:45) ☐ 3:30 Alarm – Wake immediately ★ ☐ 3:30 Wake gratitude - thank the universe ☐ 3:31 Tongue scraper (copper) ☐ 3:32 Oil pull (coconut oil) ☐ 3:33 Cold water dive reflex ★ ☐ 3:35 Spit oil pull + rinse ☐ 3:36 Brush teeth ☐ 3:37 Fenugreek water (soaked overnight) ☐ 3:40 Collagen 15g + amla (vit C) ☐ 3:42 Pre-run hydration – 500-750ml + pinch of salt	BRAHMA MUHURTA (3:45-4:05) ☐ 3:45 Marma point self-massage ☐ 3:47 Pranayama (Nadi Shodhana) ☐ 3:52 Japa (108 beads) ☐ 3:58 Thai forest meditation ☐ 4:00 Ho'oponopono prayer (morning) ☐ 4:02 Brahmacharya mala (intention set)	PRE-TRAIN (5:40-6:00) ☐ 5:40 Oats bowl (pre-train fuel) ☐ 5:45 Creatine 5g (daily – rest days too) ★ ☐ 5:47 Hard-day fuel – 2-3 dates / 1 banana ☐ 5:48 Ikigai spoken aloud ☐ 5:50 2-min visualization - see the day executed ★ ☐ 5:52 Box breathing (4-4-4-4)	POST-TRAIN (7:15-7:45) ☐ 7:15 Post-workout meal FIRST (whey + carbs) + L-carnitine ☐ 7:25 Hot shower (38-42°C, 10 min) ☐ 7:35 Moisturiser + sunscreen ☐ 7:42 Free writing ☐ 7:45 Calf + soleus micro-dose – 15 min (We AM + Tu PM)	MID-MORNING (8:45-9:00) ☐ 8:45 Ginger lime shot ☐ 8:46 Chyawanprash (1 tsp) ☐ 8:48 Shata Pada (100 steps after meal) ☐ 8:50 Sunlight exposure (5 min) ★ ☐ 8:52 Vitamins (D3+K2, algal Omega-3 ≥1g, B12) ★ ☐ 8:53 Fruit break – jamun / pomegranate / berries ☐ 8:54 Review time blocks for the day
	STUDY 1+2 (4:05-5:45) ☐ 4:05 Coffee + L-theanine – phone-free ☐ 4:15 STUDY 1+2 – 90 min: INTERVIEW PREP + CODING ★	RUNS – WEEKLY MAP ☐ 5:00 RUN – We LONG 5:00 AM · Tu easy 4:15 PM · Su brick ★	STUDY 2 / GYM (7:30-8:50) ☐ 7:50 STUDY 2 – 60 min: STOCK MARKET (Tu/Th/Fr: GYM instead) ★	MARKET (9:00-3:00) ☐ 9:00 MARKET OPEN – at the desk 9:00-3:00 ★
		SWIM (6:00-6:50) ☐ 6:00 SWIM – daily except Wednesday ★		DESK PREP (8:45-9:00) ☐ 8:45 Lunch dabba ready – desk lunch at 1:30 ☐ 8:50 Desk ready – market prep (office days: leave ~8:20)

17 items · ALL TIMES PM

PRE-LUNCH RESET (12:00-1:25) ☐ 12:00 Posture reset + desk ergonomics ☐ 12:05 20-20-20 eye rule ☐ 12:10 Hydration check (750ml by noon) ☐ 1:00 Standing stretch (5 min) ☐ 1:10 Box breathing (2 min)	LUNCH WINDOW (1:30-2:00) ☐ 1:30 Lunch – salad+dal, FIRST, paneer/dahi, roti LAST ★ ☐ 1:50 Shata Pada (100 steps after lunch) ☐ 1:55 Warm water (copper vessel)	POST-MARKET (3:05-5:30) ☐ 3:05 STUDY 3 – 40 min: MARKET REVIEW / flex (Tue: run 4:15 after) ★	AFTERNOON FUEL (3:30-4:00) ☐ 3:30 DECAF green tea + L-Theanine ☐ 3:35 Handful of soaked almonds/walnuts ☐ 3:40 Afternoon sunlight (5 min) ☐ 3:45 Micro-gratitude (1 thing)	WRAP UP (5:00-5:30) ☐ 5:00 End-of-work task review ☐ 5:10 Inbox zero pass ☐ 5:20 Shutdown ritual – "Shutdown complete"
				FUEL TOP-UP (5:00-5:30) ☐ 5:00 5 PM top-up – sattu shake / fruit + PB + 2 kiwis ★

31 items · ALL TIMES PM

EVENING – 7 PM SHUTDOWN ☐ 7:00 Laptop close – HARD STOP ★ ☐ 7:01 PHONE OFF → hall drawer (lives in the HALL, travels nowhere; ON 9:00) ★ ☐ 7:02 Internet OFF ☐ 7:10 Shata Pada (100 steps)	NIGHT PREP (7:12-7:22) ☐ 7:12 Tomorrow planning (time blocks) ☐ 7:14 Fill copper vessel + soak methi + oats ☐ 7:15 Kit packed – tomorrow's sport ☐ 7:16 Clothes laid out (run + gym kit) ☐ 7:17 Supplements laid out ☐ 7:18 Keys + essentials ready ☐ 7:19 Hot water ready (thermos) ☐ 7:20 Loban (frankincense) lit	SKIN + OIL RITUALS (7:25-7:48) ☐ 7:32 Coconut oil (face + body) ☐ 7:35 Nasya oil (2 drops per nostril) ☐ 7:40 Mula Bandha practice ☐ 7:42 Abhyanga (self oil massage) ☐ 7:45 Shilajit (ICP-MS COA-verified ONLY) ☐ 7:47 Olive oil on navel	WIND DOWN + SLEEP (7:50-8:05) ☐ 7:50 Magnesium glycinate + Glycine + Triphala (cycled) ★ ☐ 7:52 Milk + paneer + Ashwagandha – night closed	REFLECTION + SLEEP (8:05-8:45) ☐ 8:05 Roman Examen (review of conscience) ☐ 8:08 3 Wins of the day ☐ 8:12 Reverse day replay (end to start) ☐ 8:15 Gratitude (3 things) ☐ 8:18 Trataka (candle gazing) ☐ 8:22 Ho'oponopono prayer ☐ 8:25 Cyclic sighing (5 min) ★ ☐ 8:40 Evening oral care - brush + interdental ☐ 8:45 LIGHTS OUT ★
			DAY CLOSE (8:05) ☐ 8:05 Night prep confirmed ✓ ☐ 8:06 All electronics on charge - OUTSIDE bedroom	

Sat + Sun only

SATURDAY ☐ SAT Laundry – wash + dry ☐ SAT Sun-tri prep – bottles + bike in car · lights out 8:30 ☐ SAT Hammam scrub – kessa mitt full body ☐ SAT Brahmi/Bhringraj hair oiling – overnight ☐ SAT Kesar + raw milk face mask – 15 min ☐ SAT Car interior clean	SUNDAY ☐ SUN Abhyanga full body self-massage – 10-15 min ☐ SUN Temple visit ☐ SUN Park or nature sit – 1h min (Shinrin-yoku) ☐ SUN Friluftsliv – 20-30 min purposeless walk ☐ SUN Kesar + raw milk face mask ☐ SUN Brahmi/bhringraj hair oiling ☐ SUN PERMA weekly audit – P E R M A each 1-10 ☐ SUN Grocery + weekly prep + soak methi (+ jamun/kiwi/millet/sattu) ☐ SUN Full room reset + clothes fold ☐ SUN Rest – minimal tasks only
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◇ 25 LONGEVITY PILLARS				the foundation – read weekly			
1 Wake before sunrise	5 Pranayama (Nadi Shodhana)	9 Hara Hachi Bu (eat to 80%)	13 Turmeric + black pepper	17 Nasya (nasal oil)	22 Earthing / grounding		
2 Tongue scraping (copper)	6 Meditation (Vipassana)	10 Triphala before bed	14 Intermittent fasting (16:8)	18 Strength training 3x/wk	23 Amla (daily)		
3 Oil pulling (Gandusha)	7 Zone-2 cardio	11 Ashwagandha	15 Abhyanga (oil massage)	19 Forest bathing (weekly)	24 Japa / mantra		
4 Cold water exposure	8 Sunlight – first 30 min	12 Green tea (matcha)	16 Sleep – before 10 PM	20 Ekadashi fast (2x/mo)	25 Ikigai – purpose		
				21 Qigong / Tai Chi			
◇ KEY PRACTICES – how to do them							
Box breathing: in 4 · hold 4 · out 4 · hold 4 – x5 rounds		Nadi Shodhana: alternate-nostril, equal in/out – 5 min		Mula Bandha: root lock – engage 10s, release – 10 reps		Abhyanga: warm oil, toward the heart, 10-15 min	
Cyclic sighing: 2 short nose inhales → 1 long mouth exhale – 5 min		Kapalabhati: sharp exhales, passive inhale – 30-50		Shata Pada: 100 gentle steps after every meal		Cold dive reflex: face in cold water – resets the vagus nerve	
		Trataka: steady gaze on candle flame, no blink – 5 min					
		Marma: Ajna · Hridaya · Nabhi – 30s each, clockwise					

